

1. Let

$$f(t) = t^3 + t + 1, \quad g(t) = t^2 + t + 1.$$

Compute explicitly in $\mathbb{F}_2[t]$:

$$f + g,$$

$$fg,$$

and

$$f^2.$$

Write the final answers with coefficients reduced in $\mathbb{F}_2$.

2. Let F be a field. Determine all units of

$$F[t].$$

Prove your claim. You may use

$$\deg(fg) = \deg f + \deg g$$

for nonzero polynomials.

3. List all monic quadratic polynomials

$$f \in \mathbb{F}_2[t].$$

For each one, determine whether it is reducible or irreducible. You may use the root criterion for quadratics. Be explicit about which elements of $\mathbb{F}_2$ must be checked.

4. Let

$$f, g \in F[t]$$

be nonzero polynomials and suppose

$$f \mid g.$$

Prove that

$$\deg f \leq \deg g.$$

Then determine what additional conclusion follows if

$$\deg f = \deg g.$$

Do not assume the second conclusion; derive it from the definition of divisibility and the degree formula.

5. Consider the two statements:

$$6 = 2 \cdot 3$$

in $\mathbb{Z}$, and

$$t^2 + t = t(t + 1)$$

in $\mathbb{F}_2[t]$. Explain precisely, using the definitions of divisibility and irreducibility, in what sense

$$t \quad \text{and} \quad t + 1$$

play roles analogous to prime factors. Then answer: Is $t^2 + t + 1$ irreducible over $\mathbb{F}_2$?

Give a proof, not merely a factor search.